

Safety escalation policy

SAFETY POLICY

POL-SAFETY-001

Owner: Head of Operations | Effective: 01 July 2026 | Review cycle: quarterly | Applies to email, portal and coordinator-created requests.

Purpose and operating principle

This standard protects customers, site staff and Northstar technicians when the first report may indicate an immediate hazard. The service desk is not a remote emergency-diagnosis function. When the signal is credible, speed means escalating cleanly, preserving evidence and avoiding advice that could increase exposure.

Immediate escalation

Reports involving a suspected fuel or gas leak, smoke, water near electrical equipment, or people feeling dizzy or unwell in an equipment room require immediate human escalation.

The intake system must not provide troubleshooting instructions or create an automatic dispatch for these cases. It should preserve the original report, identify the safety signal and route the case to the duty owner.

Required first action

- Keep people away from the affected area and preserve the customer's original wording.
- Mark the request for immediate human review.
- Do not diagnose the fault, offer repair instructions or create a work order automatically.

What is not automatically a safety escalation

An equipment alarm, loss of cooling, unusual noise or failed start is not automatically an immediate hazard when the reporter explicitly confirms there is no smoke, smell, water, exposed electrical equipment or person at risk. Those requests still need normal triage. If the description is ambiguous, ask one concise safety question before progressing.

Minimum escalation record

- Original request ID, channel, sender and received time.
- The exact words that triggered the escalation; do not replace them with a generic label.
- Customer, site and asset if confidently known. Do not delay escalation to resolve them.
- Who was notified, when, and whether the customer acknowledged the safety instruction.

Examples

Escalate: a guard reports diesel odour and a wet patch below a generator; staff feel light-headed in a closed plant room; water is collecting beside an electrical panel; smoke is visible from an equipment enclosure.

Continue normal triage: a compressor is losing pressure with no heat, smell or leak reported; an HVAC unit is noisy but cooling; a generator fails a scheduled start test and the site confirms there is no immediate hazard.

Exception handling

If later information clears the immediate hazard, the duty owner - not the intake automation - releases the request back to standard triage. The audit record keeps both the original signal and the release decision.

Shared by Northstar Field Services for this engagement.